CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

REAL ESTATE INVESTOR (FLIPS) IN THE AI ERA

Buy the ugliest house on the street, fix what scares everyone else, sell the relief.

★ TL;DR — Around $150K a year for an active flipper who keeps deals moving, with the first flip realistically started within 1–6 months of preparation. The catch: one bad purchase price or one runaway renovation can eat a year of profit. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

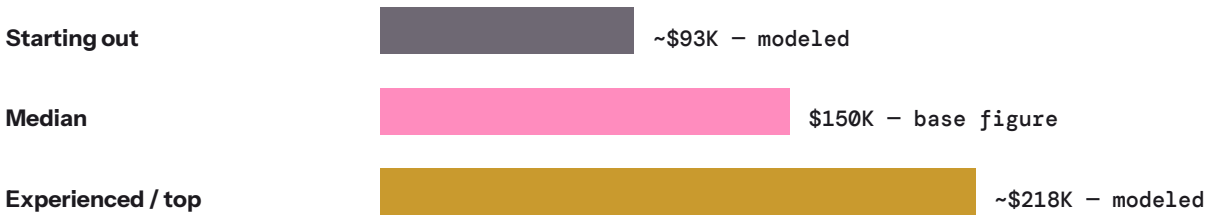
OUR TAKE: YES

MEDIAN ~$150K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Profit is locked in at purchase — the renovation just collects it, or leaks it.
- You are not buying houses; you are buying problems at a discount and selling certainty.
- Contractors, timelines and holding costs decide the real margin, not the before-and-after photos.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Real Estate Investor (flips) is a ~$150K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A REAL ESTATE INVESTOR (FLIPS) ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Find undervalued properties: motivated sellers, auctions, wholesalers, tired landlords
- ✓ Underwrite every deal: purchase, renovation, holding and selling costs against realistic resale
- ✓ Manage contractors, permits, timelines and the budget daily
- ✓ Stage, list and sell — then do the taxes and start the hunt again

Think: a rescue service for houses — you get paid for speed, nerve and knowing what a repair actually costs.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI scours listings, estimates values, drafts seller outreach and models deals in minutes. Finding candidates is no longer the bottleneck it was.	Walking the house stays human: the smell of water damage, the neighbor situation, the foundation crack the photos hid. And negotiating with a seller in a hard life moment is a trust job, not a data job.

⚠ **TV flips lie by omission: holding costs, permit delays, contractor surprises and a market that can cool mid-renovation. If your margin needs everything to go right, you do not have a margin.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Big, tangible wins — a wreck becomes the best house on the block ✓ No boss and no inventory that expires ✓ Every deal teaches the market faster than any course	✗ Huge sums at risk on every single deal ✗ Contractors and permits run on their own clocks ✗ Income arrives in lumps, months apart

Good fit? A numbers-disciplined operator with capital or financing access, contractor relationships and the stomach to walk away from almost every deal.
Bad fit? You fall in love with houses, underestimate repairs, or need steady monthly income from day one.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — BUY, RENOVATE, SELL (CLASSIC FLIP)	DOOR B — WHOLESALE AND ASSIGN FIRST

The standard route: buy below market with financing lined up first — cash, hard money or a partner — renovate to the neighborhood's standard (not beyond it), and sell. Your first deal should be boring: cosmetic, structural sound, in an area you know.	Start without buying: find motivated sellers, put properties under contract and assign the contract to flippers and landlords for a fee. You learn deal-finding and underwriting with far less capital at risk — where legal and done with proper contracts.

Smart move: Fall in love with the spreadsheet, not the house: decide your maximum price from the resale value backwards, write it down, and let sellers say no. The deals you walk away from pay for the ones you take.

Where you land after: A repeatable deal pipeline — then bigger projects, a rental portfolio fed by your best finds, or your own renovation crew.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN YOUR	LINE UP	BUILD THE	UNDERWRITE FIFTY	BUY THE	MANAGE THE

STEP 1 — Learn your market street by street

FREE · 2-4 WEEKS

- Pick one or two neighborhoods and learn what finished homes actually sell for, and how fast.
- Tour listings and open houses as a buyer of data, not of houses.

STEP 2 — Line up money before deals

FREE · 2-6 WEEKS

- Know your funding to the dollar: cash, credit lines, hard-money terms or a money partner.
- Flipping without permits knowledge is gambling — learn your city's permit and inspection process now.

STEP 3 — Build the contractor bench

FREE · 2-4 WEEKS

- Interview contractors and get sample bids before you own anything; the good ones are booked ahead.
- Get real renovation numbers per square foot for your area — your underwriting is only as good as these.

STEP 4 — Underwrite fifty deals on paper

FREE · ONGOING

- Run full numbers on every candidate: buy, fix, hold, sell, profit — with a surprise allowance.
- Expect to reject almost all of them. That rejection rate is the business working correctly.

STEP 5 — Buy the boring first deal

CAPITAL · MONTHS 2-6

- Cosmetic-heavy, structurally sound, priced with real margin after conservative resale numbers.
- Use licensed contractors for the licensed trades and pull permits — cutting corners here is how flippers end up owning a lawsuit.

STEP 6 — Manage the renovation like a job site

PAID · 4-12 WEEKS

- Written scope, draw schedule tied to finished work, weekly walk-throughs with photos.
- Every change order gets priced and approved in writing before work happens, not after.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- ☐ Today: pick your target neighborhood and pull twenty recent sales to learn real prices.
- ☐ Days 1–30: secure your funding picture and build the contractor bench with real bid numbers.
- ☐ Days 31–60: underwrite deals daily on paper; make offers only where the conservative math works.
- ☐ Days 61–90: close the first boring deal if the numbers hold — or have a pipeline warm if they do not.
- ☐ Day 90: first renovation running or first offers rejected for the right reasons. Both are progress; guessing is not.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **YOU MAKE THE MONEY WHEN YOU BUY.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.